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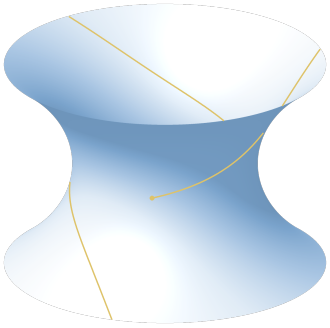
Federal Fraud Expansion
Working Document

Fraud review plan

Top 33 agencies

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We navigate our clients from a challenging problem to a defensible solution along the shortest rigorous path.

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Status: Draft v0.1 (2026-10-27), for Steve's review. **Builds on:** the top 33 ranking, the 33 agency briefs in docs/agencies/ and the working plan.

1 Bottom line

This plan turns the 33 agency briefs into a dated program of work in two phases.

- **Phase 1 (public data, 2026-11-02 to 2027-03-05, 16 working weeks).** Build one shared data spine and case library, then run a defined review of every agency using only public data. Seven agencies get full prototypes (HHS, DoD, SBA, USDA, DHS, DOT, GSA). Five get contained pilots (FCC, OPM, VA, Commerce, PBGC). The rest are covered by three shared screens (contractors, research awards, grantees) or, where payee data is closed, by an aggregate screen plus a data-access proposal. Every agency ends Phase 1 with a written finding and a ranked lead list or a reasoned "nothing actionable from public data".
- **Phase 2 (internal data, from 2027-03 through 2028).** Use the Phase 1 results to win data agreements, starting with Inspectors General, who already hold the data and the authority to act on it. Internal data moves the work from risky *entities* to specific false *claims and payments*, which is what prosecutors need, and makes pre-payment prevention possible. The first internal-data pilots can realistically start around 2027-07; agreements are the long pole, not the analytics.

The plan rests on three choices worth checking:

1. **Leads, not accusations.** Public-data findings are risk indicators. Nothing is published or named outside a referral to the responsible Inspector General or DOJ component.
2. **Build once, apply 33 times.** About 70% of the Phase 1 effort goes into shared assets (entity spine, case library, scoring, lead package). Each added agency then costs days, not months.
3. **Start Phase 2 paperwork in Phase 1.** Data agreements take 3 to 12 months, so access requests go out in week 8, not after Phase 1 ends.

2 Scope and ground rules

2.1 What "a thorough review" means here

For each of the 33 agencies, the review answers five questions:

1. **Where is the money?** Which programs and payment streams carry the agency's outlays, and which are fraud-prone.
2. **What fraud is known?** Improper payment estimates, OIG and GAO findings, and charged cases, by scheme.
3. **What can public data see?** Which payees, awards and relationships are visible, and which are not.
4. **What does the data show?** Ranked leads from the screens in this plan, each with stated reasons and a validation result.



5. **What would internal data add?** The Phase 2 data request, access route and expected payoff.

The output for each agency is a **review memo** (one to three pages, `docs/reviews/<agency>.md`) plus, where there are findings, a **lead package** (see "Lead packages" below).

2.2 Ground rules

- **Public and lawfully obtained data only in Phase 1.** That includes federal open data, state public records, court records, FOIA releases and licensed commercial data. No scraping behind logins, no personal data beyond what the source publishes.
- **Findings are leads.** A lead needs at least two independent risk signals and a written reason before it leaves the analysis team. No lead names a person in any public document.
- **Referral, not publicity.** Leads go to the agency OIG or the DOJ component named in each brief. Counsel reviews the referral route before the first package goes out, including False Claims Act public-disclosure and original-source questions and the DOJ whistleblower program at america.gov/fraud.
- **Reproducible.** Every number in a memo traces to a script and a dated data pull in the repo, so results can be rerun and defended.
- **Scored honestly.** Each screen is tested against known cases (see "Validation") and the hit rate is reported, including when it is poor.

2.3 Team assumptions (to confirm)

The timeline assumes a core team of five, plus the SBA team (Rosemary) as method owner:

Role	Short name	Main job
Program lead	Lead	Plan, agency contacts, reviews, briefings (Steve or delegate)
Data engineer	DE	Ingest, entity resolution, pipelines
Analyst (x2)	AN	Screens, scoring, validation, review memos
Fraud investigator	INV	Case library, lead review, referral packages
SBA team	SBA	Playbook, method review, reuse of SBA code

With fewer people, keep the order and stretch the dates; the shared foundation (weeks 1 to 4) must not be cut.

3 Phase 1: public-data review

3.1 Timeline at a glance

Week 1 starts Monday 2026-11-02. Weeks skip the holiday break (2026-12-21 to 2027-01-01), so week 8 starts 2027-01-04 and week 16 ends 2027-03-05. Thanksgiving week (week 4) counts as a short week.



Weeks	Dates	Focus	Main outputs
1-2	Nov 2 - Nov 13	Foundation: playbook, data spine, case library v0, FOIA requests filed	`docs/playbook/sba-baseline.md`, spine v0, FOIA log
3-4	Nov 16 - Nov 27	Foundation finished; Wave 1 screens start (HHS, DoD, SBA)	Spine v1, scoring framework, lead package template
5-7	Nov 30 - Dec 18	Wave 1 screens validated; Wave 2 starts (DHS, USDA, DOT, GSA)	Wave 1 lead lists and memos (HHS, DoD, SBA)
8-10	Jan 4 - Jan 22	Wave 2 finished; pilots (FCC, OPM, VA, Commerce, PBGC); Phase 2 access requests sent	Wave 2 lead lists, pilot results, 6 access proposals
11-13	Jan 25 - Feb 12	Shared screens across remaining agencies; aggregate screens	Contractor, research and grantee screen results; aggregate memos
14-15	Feb 15 - Feb 26	Review memos for all 33; lead package QA; counsel review	33 review memos, referral packages
16	Mar 1 - Mar 5	Briefings and Phase 1 report	Phase 1 report, leadership deck, Phase 2 go/no-go

3.2 Workstreams by week

Workstream	Agencies	Weeks	First result
F. Shared foundation	All	1-4, upkeep after	Week 4
A1. Wave 1 deep dives	HHS, DoD, SBA	3-7	Week 7
A2. Wave 2 deep dives	DHS, USDA, DOT, GSA	5-10	Week 10
B. Contained pilots	FCC, OPM, VA, Commerce, PBGC	7-11	Week 11
C1. Contractor screen	USACE, NASA, DOE, State, NRC, DHS and VA contracts	9-13	Week 13
C2. Research award screen	NSF, DOE, NASA, PCORTF, DoD, HHS (NIH)	9-12	Week 12
C3. Grantee screen	EPA, DOJ, AmeriCorps, HUD, USAID, State, EOP, DFC	10-13	Week 13
D. Aggregate screens and access cases	Treasury, SSA, DOL, ED, HUD tenants, FDIC, DOI	10-14	Week 14
E. Data partners	GSA, DOJ, SEC, SSA	2-10, in parallel	Week 6 (DOJ case library)
R. Memos, referrals, briefings	All	14-16	Week 16

3.3 Shared foundation (weeks 1 to 4)

These items serve every agency and come first. Each has an owner, a due week and a test for "done".



ID	Action	Owner	Due	Done when
F1	Write the SBA baseline playbook: data sources, typologies, features, scoring, measured results; mark what is SBA-only	SBA, Lead	Wk 2	`docs/playbook/sba-baseline.md` reviewed by Rosemary
F2	Stand up the repo layout (`pipelines/`, `prototypes/<agency>/`, `docs/reviews/`, `data/` manifest) and a dated-pull convention	DE	Wk 1	Every pull logged with source, URL, date, row count, hash
F3	Ingest the entity spine: SAM.gov public entity extract and exclusions, USAspending prime and subaward bulk files FY2020-FY2026, FPDS contract actions	DE	Wk 3	One table keyed by UEI with awards, addresses, POCs, exclusions
F4	Ingest watch lists: SAM exclusions, HHS-OIG LEIE, OPM OIG debarments, OFAC SDN and consolidated lists, World Bank debarred firms, HUD Limited Denial of Participation, USAC E-Rate suspensions	DE	Wk 2	One watch-list table with source and date per row
F5	Build the case library v0: DOJ press releases (justice.gov news API, all U.S. Attorneys' offices) 2020-2026, tagged by agency, program, scheme, dollars, defendants and entities	INV, AN	Wk 4 (v0), Wk 6 (v1)	At least 2,000 fraud releases tagged; entities linked to UEI or NPI where possible
F6	Add OIG reports from Oversight.gov and GAO fraud reports to the case library	INV	Wk 6	Report index with agency, program, finding type
F7	Entity resolution: reuse the SBA matcher for names, addresses (USPS-standardized), phones, officers; add NPI and EDGAR CIK keys	DE, SBA	Wk 4	Precision checked on 500 hand-labeled pairs (target 95%+)
F8	Scoring framework: common signal library (shared address, shared officer, new entity large award, excluded link, peer outlier, rapid growth), reason codes, score calibration	AN	Wk 4	Each signal documented with formula, threshold and false-positive notes
F9	Lead package template and review checklist (see below)	INV, Lead	Wk 4	Template approved by Lead
F10	File FOIA and public-records requests with long lead times (list below)	Lead	Wk 1	Requests filed and tracked in `docs/reviews/foia_log.md`
F11	Counsel review of ground rules, referral route, FCA and whistleblower questions, data licensing	Lead	Wk 6	Written guidance in `docs/playbook/legal.md`
F12	Commercial data decision: vessel manifests (DHS), corporate registries and beneficial ownership (OpenCorporates or similar)	Lead	Wk 3	Bought, or written reason not to



FOIA and records requests to file in week 1 (responses take 1 to 6 months, so file before they are needed):

- SBA: latest 7(a) and 504 loan-level releases if not already held; 8(a) and HUBZone decertification lists.
- USDA FNS: SNAP retailer disqualifications and civil money penalties by store, 2018-2026.
- CBP: published Enforce and Protect Act (EAPA) determinations list and penalty case summaries.
- Three to five state DOTs: DBE commercially-useful-function reviews and decertifications; prime-to-DBE payment reports.
- Two states (Minnesota plus one other): CACFP sponsor and site lists with meal counts by site.
- OPM: FEHB carrier provider debarment and suspension notices (if not on OPM OIG's public list).
- FSA (Education): school-level fraud referrals and Heightened Cash Monitoring reasons.

3.4 Validation

Every screen is tested the same way before its leads are used:

1. **Back-test against known cases.** Take entities charged or settled in the case library (F5) for that program. Score the population as it looked *before* the case became public. Report how many known cases land in the top 1%, 5% and 10% of scores.
2. **Hand review a sample.** The investigator reviews 25 top-scored entities that are not known cases and records whether a reasonable reviewer would want to look further.
3. **Bar for release.** A screen is released when known cases are at least five times more common in its top 5% than in the population, and at least half of the hand-reviewed sample is judged worth review. Screens that miss the bar are reported as such and reworked or dropped.

3.5 Lead packages

A lead package is what goes to an OIG or DOJ. One package per entity or network, in a fixed format:

- Summary: who, which program, how much money, which scheme it resembles.
- Signals: each risk signal with its source record and date.
- Network: related entities, shared addresses, officers, exclusions.
- Comparison: how the entity compares with its peers.
- Known-case match: the charged cases it most resembles.
- Limits: what public data cannot show, and innocent explanations checked.
- Provenance: data pulls and script versions used.

Packages are reviewed by the investigator and the program lead, then by counsel for the first ten, before referral.



3.6 Agency review plans

Agencies are listed in the order of the recommended sequence in top33.pdf. Each plan lists the review questions, the data to pull, the analyses to run, how to validate, what is delivered and when, and who receives it. Shared building blocks (F1 to F12) are assumed.

Wave 1 deep dives (weeks 3 to 7)

1. HHS: Medicare and Medicaid providers Brief. Rank 1, score 4.8. Owner: AN 1 with INV.

- **Review questions.** Which hospices and home health agencies (HHAs) in Los Angeles County and Minnesota look like sham or captive providers? Which owners link to excluded or suspended providers? Which other provider types show the same ramp-and-cluster pattern nationally?
- **Pull (weeks 2-3).** data.cms.gov: Hospice and HHA enrollments, Hospice and HHA All Owners files, Medicare Post-Acute Care and Hospice by Provider, Physicians and Other Practitioners by Provider and Service, Part D Prescribers, Public Provider Enrollment, Revoked providers list; NPPES full file and monthly deactivations; LEIE; Open Payments; Care Compare hospice measures; Head Start and child care grants from USAspending.
- **Run (weeks 3-6).**
  1. Address and owner clustering for hospices and HHAs: providers per address, shared owners and managing employees, ownership change frequency.
  2. Billing ramp: Medicare payments in the first 24 months after enrollment versus peers enrolled the same year.
  3. Peer outliers: average length of stay, share of patients with dementia-only diagnoses, live-discharge rate, payments per beneficiary, by county.
  4. Owner network links to LEIE, revoked providers and DOJ case defendants.
  5. National extension: run the same signals for durable medical equipment, laboratories and telehealth billing outliers.
- **Validate.** Back-test against providers in the May 2026 moratorium materials, payment suspensions announced for Los Angeles, and DOJ Health Care Fraud Unit cases 2020-2026.
- **Deliver (week 7).** Risk map and ranked list for the two hot spots; owner network view; national outlier table; review memo; lead packages for the top networks.
- **Take to.** CMS Center for Program Integrity, HHS-OIG Office of Investigations, DOJ Health Care Fraud Unit.

2. DoD: set-aside contractors Brief. Rank 2, score 4.3. Owner: AN 2 with SBA.

- **Review questions.** Which set-aside winners look like fronts or pass-throughs for ineligible firms? Which groups of "competitors" share control? Which awards show threshold gaming or runaway modifications?
- **Pull (weeks 2-3).** FPDS / USAspending DoD contract actions FY2021-FY2026 (set-aside type, offers received, competition, modifications, place of performance); subaward reports; SAM.gov entities and exclusions; SBA Dynamic Small Business Search and certification lists (8(a), HUBZone, WOSB, VetCert); DOJ and DCIS case releases.



- **Run (weeks 3-6).**
  1. Front-company signals: new entity with large set-aside awards, shared address or POC with a large business, high share of subaward dollars to one non-eligible firm.
  2. Collusion signals: shared officers, addresses or phones among bidders in the same market; win rotation by contracting office and NAICS code.
  3. Threshold gaming: sole-source awards clustered just under the 8(a), simplified acquisition and other dollar thresholds.
  4. Modification growth: value growth beyond award versus peers in the same product or service code.
  5. Excluded links: vendors sharing identifiers with excluded parties.
- **Validate.** DCIS and DOJ set-aside fraud cases 2018-2026 (case library); SBA decertifications from the FOIA request.
- **Deliver (week 7).** Contractor integrity screen with ranked vendors and reasons; collusion network view by market; review memo; lead packages.
- **Take to.** DoD Office of Small Business Programs, DCIS and DoD OIG, DOJ Procurement Collusion Strike Force.

3. SBA: extend the baseline Brief. Rank 3, score 4.2. Owner: SBA team with DE.

- **Review questions.** Which current (non-pandemic) loans, lenders, agents and certified firms carry the same signals as the pandemic fraud already found?
- **Pull (weeks 1-3).** 7(a) and 504 loan-level FOIA data FY2010-FY2026; PPP and EIDL data already held; 8(a), HUBZone, WOSB and VetCert lists; SBA OIG reports.
- **Run (weeks 3-6).**
  1. Apply the existing SBA identifier and address screens to 7(a) and 504.
  2. Lender and agent concentration: share of each lender's loans with pandemic fraud signals, charge-off rates versus peers.
  3. Cross-program reuse: borrowers and owners in pandemic fraud findings who now hold 7(a), 504 or contracting certifications.
- **Validate.** Existing SBA results and SBA OIG cases; PPP and EIDL cases inside the 10-year limitation period (extended by 2022 law), which keeps them prosecutable to 2030-2032.
- **Deliver (week 6).** Updated SBA results across all loan programs; lender risk table (shared with FDIC); playbook v1.
- **Take to.** SBA Office of Credit Risk Management, SBA OIG.

Wave 2 deep dives (weeks 5 to 10)

4. DHS: customs evasion and FEMA Brief. Rank 4, score 3.9. Owner: AN 1.

- **Review questions.** In which high-duty product lines do U.S. imports from a country exceed that country's reported exports to the U.S.? Which importers of record drive the gap? Which FEMA contractors and public assistance recipients look like shells?



- **Pull (weeks 4-6).** Census USA Trade Online imports by HTS-10 and country; UN Comtrade partner exports for mirror checks; ITA list of active antidumping and countervailing duty orders and Section 301 / 232 tariff lists; CBP EAPA determinations; vessel manifest data from a licensed vendor (decision F12); OpenFEMA Public Assistance Funded Projects Details and Hazard Mitigation projects; DHS contracts from FPDS.
- **Run (weeks 6-9).**

  1. Mirror gap: product-country pairs with the largest unexplained gaps after tariff changes, for two product groups first (for example aluminum extrusions and plastic resin).
  2. Shell importers: new importers of record after a tariff change, sharing addresses or officers with penalized firms, using residential or registered-agent addresses.
  3. Country-of-origin shifts: shippers whose declared origin moves to a third country right after a duty change.
  4. FEMA contractor screen: shared foundation signals on disaster awards, plus out-of-area firms winning large awards within 30 days of a declaration.

- **Validate.** Trade Fraud Task Force resolutions and customs False Claims Act settlements 2020-2026; EAPA determinations.
- **Deliver (week 10).** Importer lead list with reasons for two product groups; FEMA contractor table; review memo.
- **Take to.** CBP Office of Trade, HSI, DOJ-DHS Trade Fraud Task Force, FEMA Fraud Investigations and Inspections Division, DHS OIG.

5. USDA: SNAP retailers and child meal sponsors Brief. Rank 4, score 3.9. Owner: AN 2.

- **Review questions.** Which SNAP retailers look like trafficking fronts? Which CACFP and summer meal sponsors claim more than their area can support? Which farm disaster payments go to linked or outlier entities?
- **Pull (weeks 4-6).** FNS historical SNAP retailer locator data (authorization and end dates, store type, location) 2005-2026; FNS disqualifications (FOIA); federal court retailer appeal cases (CourtListener / PACER); SNAP participation by county; ACS child population by tract; state CACFP sponsor and site lists (FOIA, two states); USAspending USDA grants and direct payments; EWG farm subsidy data or FSA payment FOIA files.
- **Run (weeks 6-9).**

  1. Retailer clusters: small stores authorized near disqualified stores, owner and address reuse after disqualification, store density versus SNAP households.
  2. Sponsor capacity: meals claimed per site versus children living nearby, site growth rates, sponsors serving many sites with shared addresses or officers (the Feeding Our Future pattern).
  3. Farm disaster outliers: Emergency Conservation Program and NAP payments far above county peers; linked entities across payees.

- **Validate.** Feeding Our Future defendants and sites; disqualified retailers (the FOIA list) as labels for the retailer screen.
- **Deliver (week 10).** SNAP retailer risk map for two states; sponsor screen for one state; farm payment outlier table; review memo.



- **Take to.** FNS Retailer Operations Division, USDA OIG, state SNAP and child nutrition agencies.

6. DOT: DBE fronts and bid rigging Brief. Rank 6, score 3.7. Owner: AN 1 with SBA.

- **Review questions.** Which certified DBEs look like fronts for their primes? Where do bidders rotate wins or share control? Where is DBE participation promised but never paid?
- **Pull (weeks 5-7).** Unified Certification Program DBE directories for three states (for example Pennsylvania, Illinois, California); state DOT bid tabulations for the same states, 2019-2026; USAspending FHWA, FTA and FAA grants and subawards; state FOIA responses on DBE reviews; DOT OIG and DOJ DBE cases.
- **Run (weeks 7-9).**
  1. Front signals: DBEs sharing addresses, phones or officers with a prime; DBEs that work for one prime; DBEs with work codes they lack equipment or staff for (from state contractor prequalification data).
  2. Bid rotation: complementary bids, stable bid ranks, bidders who never beat each other, using all bids per letting.
  3. Participation gap: DBE commitments at award versus subaward reports.
- **Validate.** Charged DBE cases (case library) and state decertifications.
- **Deliver (week 10).** DBE integrity screen and bid rotation report for three states; review memo; method note for other states.
- **Take to.** DOT OIG, FHWA Office of Civil Rights, state DOT DBE offices, DOJ Procurement Collusion Strike Force.

7. GSA: SAM.gov integrity and schedules Brief. Rank 6, score 3.7. Owner: DE with AN 2.

- **Review questions.** How many active SAM.gov registrations share addresses, POCs or officers in ways that suggest shells? Which firms re-register after exclusion? Which schedule prices and leases are outliers?
- **Pull (weeks 5-7).** SAM.gov entity extract (already in spine) with history; CALC+ labor rate data; GSA Advantage product prices for a sample of high-volume items; GSA lease inventory (IOLP); GSA OIG and DOJ schedule pricing settlements.
- **Run (weeks 7-9).**
  1. Registration clusters government-wide, ranked by award dollars (the SBA entity screen at full scale).
  2. Re-registration: new UEIs that share officers, addresses or phone numbers with excluded entities.
  3. Labor rate and product price outliers by category.
  4. Lease outliers: rent per square foot versus local comparables; lessor entity links.
- **Validate.** Excluded entities that re-registered (known from the exclusion record history); schedule FCA settlements.
- **Deliver (week 10).** SAM.gov registration integrity report (also offered to GSA as a data-quality product); price and lease outlier tables.



- **Take to.** GSA Integrated Award Environment (SAM.gov), Federal Acquisition Service, GSA OIG.

Contained pilots (weeks 7 to 11)

8. FCC: Universal Service Fund Brief. Rank 8, score 3.5. Owner: AN 2.

- **Pull (week 7).** USAC Open Data: E-Rate FCC Forms 470 and 471, commitments and disbursements by applicant and provider, funding years 2016-2026; Lifeline disbursements by provider and state; Rural Health Care commitments; Affordable Connectivity Program enrollment by ZIP (ended 2024); FCC Form 499 filer database; USAC suspensions and FCC enforcement actions.
- **Run (weeks 8-10).** E-Rate single-bid share by consultant and provider; price per unit versus peers for the same service; provider-consultant links through shared addresses or officers; Lifeline and ACP enrollment per eligible household by area and provider.
- **Validate.** E-Rate kickback and bid rigging cases; FCC Lifeline enforcement actions.
- **Deliver (week 11).** E-Rate network map and ranked relationships; Lifeline and ACP provider outlier table; review memo.
- **Take to.** FCC Enforcement Bureau and OIG, USAC Internal Audit.

9. OPM: FEHB exclusions Brief. Rank 11, score 3.3. Owner: AN 1.

- **Pull (week 7).** OPM OIG debarment list, LEIE, SAM exclusions (all in F4); NPPES with deactivations; state medical board actions for five large states.
- **Run (weeks 8-9).** Reconcile the three exclusion lists on name, NPI, address and license; count providers excluded by HHS or SAM but missing from OPM's list; flag deactivated or deceased-provider NPIs still listed as active in public carrier directories (sample of carriers).
- **Validate.** GAO-26-108139 counts (at least 1,200 LEIE entries missing from OPM's list) as the benchmark.
- **Deliver (week 10).** Reconciliation report with matched identifiers; review memo.
- **Take to.** OPM Healthcare and Insurance, OPM OIG.

10. VA: SDVOSB contracts and GI Bill schools Brief. Rank 8, score 3.5. Owner: AN 2.

- **Pull (week 7).** VA contracts from the spine; VetCert lists; GI Bill Comparison Tool data with caution flags; VBA annual benefits report by state and county.
- **Run (weeks 8-10).** DoD contractor screen on VA awards; SDVOSBs whose subaward dollars go mostly to non-veteran firms; schools with fast GI Bill growth, caution flags or owners tied to closed schools; county compensation rates far above veteran population and age norms.
- **Validate.** VA OIG and DOJ SDVOSB cases; schools already sanctioned.
- **Deliver (week 11).** VA contractor results, school watch list, county outlier table, review memo.
- **Take to.** VA OSDBU, VBA Education Service, VA OIG.



11. Commerce: BEAD and CHIPS Brief. Rank 11, score 3.3. Owner: AN 1.

- **Pull (week 8).** State BEAD final proposals and subgrantee selections for three states with published awards; FCC National Broadband Map availability data; USF history per provider (from the FCC pilot); CHIPS and EDA awards from USAspending.
- **Run (weeks 9-10).** Funded locations already shown as served; provider history (USF enforcement, new entities, shared owners across bidders); cost per location versus peers in similar terrain.
- **Deliver (week 11).** BEAD subgrantee screen and review memo. Framed as pre-spending prevention.
- **Take to.** NTIA Office of Internet Connectivity and Growth, Commerce OIG, state broadband offices.

12. PBGC: Special Financial Assistance Brief. Rank 24, score 2.5. Owner: AN 2.

- **Pull (week 8).** PBGC's posted SFA applications and approvals (plan, amount, census and actuarial exhibits); Form 5500 and Schedule MB filings from DOL EFAST2 for every SFA plan, 2015 onward.
- **Run (weeks 9-10).** Participant counts and deaths in each SFA application versus the plan's Form 5500 trend and standard mortality; rank plans by likely overcount of living participants.
- **Validate.** Central States ($127M, 3,479 deceased participants) as the known case.
- **Deliver (week 11).** Plan-level table and memo; the death-data case for SSA and Treasury (shared with SSA below).
- **Take to.** PBGC Multiemployer Program, PBGC OIG, DOL EBSA.

Shared screens (weeks 9 to 13)

The three shared screens reuse the foundation and the Wave 1 code. Each agency still gets its own section of results and its own review memo.

C1. Contractor screen (DoD code on other agencies' awards). Signals: front companies, collusion networks, threshold gaming, modification growth, excluded links, plus Davis-Bacon and wage violations from DOL Wage and Hour enforcement data.

C2. Research award screen. Pull SBIR.gov awards (all agencies, 2010-2026), NSF Award Search, NIH RePORTER, NASA TechPort and PCORI's funded projects. Run text similarity on abstracts and aims to find near-duplicate awards across agencies; flag award mills (many Phase I, no Phase II or commercialization), shared PIs across firms, and excluded links. Benchmark against GAO-24-105470 (842 high-risk awardees, about $445M possibly duplicative).

C3. Grantee screen. Join USAspending grants and subawards to SAM.gov, IRS Form 990 bulk data and the watch lists. Signals: nonprofit formed shortly before a large award, revenue far below award size, subgrant chains with shared officers, prior OIG findings, cost per participant far above peers.

13. Army Corps of Engineers Brief. Rank 14, score 3.2. C1, weeks 9-11. Run the contractor screen by Corps district; add a bid rotation view using the Corps' dredging contract history where



bids are published, and offers received from FPDS elsewhere; compare change-order growth with peer projects. Deliver district-level results and memo in week 11. Take to USACE Directorate of Contracting, Army CID Major Procurement Fraud Unit, DOJ Procurement Collusion Strike Force.

14. Energy Brief. Rank 11, score 3.3. C1 and C2, weeks 9-12. C2 duplicate-award screen on DOE SBIR/STTR; C3-style check of new infrastructure and IRA grant recipients (thin history, large awards, shared addresses); excluded links for Loan Programs Office borrowers and sponsors. Deliver in week 12. Take to DOE OIG and the DOE SBIR/STTR office.

15. Environmental Protection Agency Brief. Rank 15, score 3.1. C3, weeks 10-13. Grantee profile for the Greenhouse Gas Reduction Fund, Solar for All and state revolving fund projects: entity age, Form 990 history, subgrant chains and contractor screen on SRF construction. Facts only, no fraud labels, given the litigation. Deliver in week 13. Take to EPA Office of Grants and Debarment and EPA OIG.

16. HUD: owners and disaster grants Brief. Rank 16, score 3.0. C3 plus own owner view, weeks 10-13. Join the Multifamily Assistance and Section 8 Contracts data to inspection scores (NSPIRE/REAC), owners and management agents, the HUD Limited Denial of Participation list and SAM exclusions; rank owner networks with poor inspections and continuing payments. Run C3 on CDBG-DR subrecipients and contractors using DRGR public reports. Use Picture of Subsidized Households for area cost-per-unit outliers. Deliver in week 13. Take to HUD Office of Multifamily Housing and HUD OIG.

17. State (foreign assistance) Brief. Rank 16, score 3.0. C1 and C3, weeks 10-13. Implementing-partner profile for the ten largest recipient countries from ForeignAssistance.gov, USAspending and IATI; partner concentration and competition; links to OFAC, UN and World Bank debarment lists; overhead and unit cost outliers. Contractor screen on embassy construction and logistics. Deliver in week 13. Take to State Office of Foreign Assistance and State OIG.

18. NASA Brief. Rank 16, score 3.0. C1 and C2, weeks 9-12. NASA SBIR/STTR in the duplicate-award screen; award mill check; supplier screen on subawards under the largest primes. Deliver in week 12. Take to NASA OIG.

19. National Science Foundation Brief. Rank 16, score 3.0. C2 test bed, weeks 9-12. Use NSF data to tune the text-similarity method first (week 9), then run across all agencies. Deliver in week 12. Take to NSF OIG.

20. Justice Brief. Rank 20, score 2.9. Data partner (E) and C3. The case library (F5) is the main DOJ product, finished in week 6 and kept current weekly. In weeks 11-13 run C3 on Office of Justice Programs, OVW and COPS subgrantees and price outliers on Bureau of Prisons commissary, medical and telecom contracts. Take to Criminal Division Fraud Section, Civil Division (False Claims Act) and DOJ OIG.



21. Securities and Exchange Commission Brief. Rank 21, score 2.8. Data partner (E), weeks 5-8. Add EDGAR officers, Form D issuers and related persons to the entity spine; flag federal award recipients whose officers appear in SEC litigation or administrative releases, or in FINRA BrokerCheck disciplinary records. Delivered as a spine feature in week 8 and a short memo. Take to SEC Division of Enforcement as a data partner.

22. USAID close-out Brief. Rank 24, score 2.5. C3, weeks 11-12. Table of terminated awards with obligations far above outlays (possible unreturned advances) and partners with prior OIG findings now receiving State awards. Deliver in week 12. Take to State Office of Foreign Assistance and USAID/State OIG.

23. Development Finance Corporation Brief. Rank 29, score 2.1. C3, week 12. Sanctions and exclusions check of every borrower and sponsor in DFC's active projects list, plus ICIJ Offshore Leaks and OpenSanctions matches for shell structures. Take to DFC Office of Accountability and DFC OIG.

24. AmeriCorps Brief. Rank 30, score 2.0. C3, week 12. Grantee risk list for the Foster Grandparent and AmeriCorps State and National programs: prior OIG findings, cost per member versus peers, Form 990 revenue checks. Take to AmeriCorps Office of Grant Administration and AmeriCorps OIG.

25. PCOR Trust Fund Brief. Rank 31, score 1.8. C2, week 12. Add PCORI funded projects to the duplicate-award screen against NIH and NSF; check awardees against LEIE and SAM. Take to PCORI and HHS OIG.

26. Nuclear Regulatory Commission Brief. Rank 31, score 1.8. C1, week 13. NRC contracts in the contractor screen; match suppliers named in public 10 CFR Part 21 defect reports and NRC enforcement actions against federal contractor records. Take to NRC Office of Investigations and NRC OIG.

27. Executive Office of the President Brief. Rank 33, score 1.3. C3, week 13. Grantee screen on ONDCP's HIDTA grants. EOP's main role is as audience: the Phase 1 report is written for OMB's Office of Federal Financial Management.

Aggregate screens and access cases (weeks 10 to 14)

These agencies pay individuals whose data is confidential, so public data can point only to places, intermediaries and programs. Each gets an aggregate screen and a ready-to-send Phase 2 access proposal.

28. Treasury (IRS) Brief. Rank 8, score 3.5. Weeks 10-13. EITC and Additional Child Tax Credit hot-spot model from IRS SOI ZIP data (tax years 2015-2023) against ACS income and household predictors; overlay DOJ Tax Division preparer injunctions and IRS-CI cases; link ERC



promoter cases to PPP borrowers to size likely double dipping. Deliver the hot-spot map and an IRS data-access proposal in week 13. Take to IRS Return Preparer Office, IRS-CI, TIGTA and Treasury Office of Payment Integrity.

29. Social Security Administration Brief. Rank 22, score 2.7. Weeks 10-13. County SSI and disability outlier map from SSA state and county statistics, adjusted with ACS age and disability and CDC PLACES health data; facilitator network from charged disability cases (attorneys, doctors, representative payees recurring across cases). With PBGC and OPM results, write the cross-agency case for death data sharing. Take to SSA Office of Anti-Fraud Programs, SSA OIG and Treasury Do Not Pay.

30. Labor Brief. Rank 26, score 2.4. Weeks 11-14. State unemployment insurance dashboard from ETA 539 weekly claims, ETA 227 overpayment reports and Benefit Accuracy Measurement data: claims versus local job loss, overpayment and fraud rates versus peers. Extract schemes from charged UI cases into rules states can run (shared bank accounts, addresses, IP addresses). Also review OLMS union financial filings for embezzlement signals and EBSA plan data (with PBGC). Take to DOL ETA, DOL OIG and state workforce agencies.

31. Education Brief. Rank 22, score 2.7. Weeks 11-13. School-level ghost student risk ranking from FSA Title IV volume, Heightened Cash Monitoring list, College Scorecard and IPEDS (online share, aid growth versus completion and retention); owner links to closed or sanctioned schools. Validate against colleges named in OIG and news reports. Take to FSA Enforcement and Education OIG.

32. FDIC Brief. Rank 27, score 2.3. Weeks 10-11. PPP lender risk table joining SBA work results to FDIC BankFind and Call Reports (share of each lender's PPP loans with fraud signals, fintech partner channels). Pre-failure signal review for banks that failed 2019-2026. Take to FDIC OIG and FDIC Division of Risk Management Supervision.

33. Interior Brief. Rank 27, score 2.3. Weeks 12-14. Royalty-rate outlier table from ONRR Natural Resources Revenue Data (royalty per unit of production by company, commodity, basin and year); contractor screen on wildfire and land management contracts (C1). Take to ONRR and DOI OIG.

3.7 Phase 1 action items by week

The full list of dated action items. Owners use the short names from the team table.

Wk	Ending	Action items	Owner
1	Nov 6	F2 repo layout; F10 FOIA requests filed; F4 watch lists started; agree team and roles; confirm agency order with Steve	Lead, DE
2	Nov 13	F1 SBA playbook; F4 done; F3 spine ingest started; HHS and DoD pulls started; SBA 7(a)/504 pull	SBA, DE, AN
3	Nov 20	F3 spine v1; F12 commercial data decision; HHS and DoD screens started	DE, Lead, AN



Wk	Ending	Action items	Owner
4	Nov 27	F5 case library v0; F7 entity resolution tested; F8 scoring framework; F9 lead package template	INV, DE, AN
5	Dec 4	HHS and DoD first scores; SBA extension results; DHS and USDA pulls; SEC enrichment starts	AN, DE
6	Dec 11	F5 case library v1 and F6 OIG index; F11 counsel guidance; Wave 1 back-tests; SBA memo	INV, Lead, AN
7	Dec 18	HHS and DoD lead lists and memos; first ten lead packages to counsel; DOT and GSA pulls	AN, INV
8	Jan 8	Phase 2 access proposals sent (HHS-OIG, DoD OIG, SBA OIG, USDA OIG, DHS/CBP, GSA); FCC and OPM pilots start; SEC feature done	Lead, AN
9	Jan 15	DHS, USDA, DOT, GSA screens scored; C1 and C2 start; NSF text-similarity tuning	AN, DE
10	Jan 22	Wave 2 lead lists and memos; OPM reconciliation; C3 and aggregate screens start	AN
11	Jan 29	FCC, VA, Commerce, PBGC pilot results; USACE results	AN
12	Feb 5	C2 results (DOE, NSF, NASA, PCORTF); USAID, DFC, AmeriCorps; FDIC table	AN
13	Feb 12	C1 and C3 results (EPA, HUD, State, DOJ, NRC, EOP); Treasury and SSA access proposals	AN, Lead
14	Feb 19	DOL, ED, DOI results; all 33 review memos drafted; lead package QA	AN, INV
15	Feb 26	Counsel review of referral set; memos final; Phase 1 report drafted	Lead, INV
16	Mar 5	Referrals made; leadership briefings; Phase 2 go/no-go with Steve	Lead

3.8 Phase 1 success measures

- **Coverage.** A review memo for all 33 agencies by week 15.
- **Screen quality.** At least 10 screens pass the validation bar; hit rates reported for every screen, passing or not.
- **Leads.** At least 50 reviewed lead packages across at least 10 agencies, with the dollars they cover.
- **Access.** At least six Phase 2 access proposals sent by week 13 and at least two agencies or OIGs in active discussion by week 16.
- **Reuse.** Time to add a new agency to a shared screen under one week by week 12.

3.9 Phase 1 risks

Risk	Effect	Response
FOIA responses late	USDA, DOT, CACFP labels missing	File in week 1; fall back to court records and press releases
Manifest data cost	DHS screen weaker	Start with mirror gaps and Census data; buy one product group only
Entity matching errors	False leads	95% precision gate (F7); two-signal rule; human review
Too many leads to review	Backlog, quality drop	Cap at the top 25 per screen; investigator sets the order



Risk	Effect	Response
Political sensitivity (EPA, USAID, State)	Findings misused	Facts-only profiles; no public release; referral only
Small team	Dates slip	Keep foundation and Wave 1 fixed; shift shared screens later

4 Phase 2: internal data to identify and prosecute fraud

4.1 Why internal data matters

Public data can say *which entities look risky.* It cannot see the claim, invoice, application or payment where the fraud happens. Internal data changes three things:

1. **From entity to transaction.** Score each claim, invoice, loan or benefit payment, not just the payee.
2. **From lead to evidence.** Show the specific false statements, the dollars paid on them and who received the money. That is what a grand jury, a False Claims Act complaint or an administrative action needs.
3. **From recovery to prevention.** Run the same checks before money goes out: at enrollment, application, award and payment.

4.2 Ideas: what internal data would enable

Cross-agency ideas (highest value)

These need data from more than one agency, which no single agency can do alone. They are the strongest argument for a government-wide program.

Idea	Internal data	What it finds	Lead agencies
Shared bank account screen	Payment file bank routing and account numbers across programs	One account receiving payments for many unrelated identities or entities	Treasury Fiscal Service, all payers
Full death data everywhere	SSA full death file	Payments to dead people in FEHB, PBGC, Medicare, VA, SNAP	SSA, Treasury Do Not Pay
Identity reuse across programs	SSN, address, phone, email, device and IP at application	One identity or device behind UI, SNAP, Medicaid, SBA and student aid claims	DOL, USDA, HHS, SBA, ED (via states)
Unified payee graph	Payee TINs, owners, bank accounts across grants, contracts, loans and benefits	Hidden common control across "separate" recipients	Treasury, GSA, OMB
Excluded-party enforcement	Internal claims and payments matched to all exclusion lists	Payments to excluded parties in any program	HHS, OPM, VA, GSA
Incarceration check	Bureau of Prisons and state prison data	Benefits paid to prisoners	DOJ, SSA, DOL, USDA



Agency ideas

Agency	Internal data	What it enables	Access route
HHS	Medicare claims, Medicaid T-MSIS claims, enrollment applications, PECOS, MA encounter data	Claim-level scoring; impossible-day and phantom-patient tests; MA risk-adjustment upcoding; patient recruitment rings	HHS-OIG; CMS Center for Program Integrity; CMS research data (VRDC) for analysis
DoD	Invoices (WAWF / PIEE), DCAA audits, subcontract payment data, CAGE and bid data	Invoice fraud, cost mischarging, losing bids for collusion tests, real pass-through shares	DCIS, DoD OIG, DPCAP
SBA	Loan applications, lender files, bank account and device data	Application-level identity fraud, lender and agent rings	SBA OIG (existing work)
USDA	SNAP EBT transactions (via states), retailer redemption data, CACFP claims	Trafficking from transaction patterns; sponsor claim tests	FNS; USDA OIG; state agencies
DHS	CBP entry data (ACE: declared value, origin, duty), FEMA applicant and payment data	Importer-level underpayment; duplicate disaster claims	CBP Office of Trade; HSI; FEMA FIID
DOT	Prime-to-DBE payments, state DBE review files	Proof of pass-through: money in versus work done	State DOTs; DOT OIG
GSA	SAM.gov sensitive fields (TINs, bank data), SmartPay transactions	Shell detection by shared TIN and bank account; purchase card misuse	GSA IAE; GSA OIG
Treasury	Returns, preparer PTINs on returns, ERC claims, payment files	Preparer-level EITC scoring; ERC claim screening; bank account reuse	IRS (6103 limits, see below); TIGTA
SSA	Payee and representative payee data, disability claims, full death file	Facilitator rings; payee abuse; death data for other agencies	SSA OIG; CDI units
VA	Compensation claims, community care claims, GI Bill enrollment certifications	Claim-level scoring; provider screens; school enrollment checks	VA OIG
OPM	FEHB carrier claims, retirement payee data	Provider claims after death or exclusion; dead annuitants	OPM OIG
DOL	State UI claims (identity, bank, IP data)	Cross-state duplicate claims, ring detection	States; DOL OIG; NASWA Integrity Data Hub
ED	FAFSA and enrollment data	Ghost student detection at application	FSA; Education OIG
HUD	Tenant income (EIV), payment and inspection files	Unreported income; landlord billing for empty units	HUD OIG; HUD CFO
FCC	USAC Lifeline subscriber data (National Verifier), E-Rate bid documents	Duplicate and phantom subscribers; full bid analysis	USAC; FCC OIG
Commerce	BEAD build-out verification, CHIPS milestone reports	Claimed coverage versus delivered	NTIA; Commerce OIG



Agency	Internal data	What it enables	Access route
PBGC	Participant data for SFA plans	Participant-level death checks	PBGC OIG
DOE, NSF, NASA, PCORTF	Full proposals and budgets, PI current-and-pending support	Duplicate funding at the proposal level	Each OIG
EPA, DOJ grants, AmeriCorps	Subrecipient financial reports, timesheets	Unsupported costs, stipend fraud	Each OIG
State, USAID, DFC	Partner financial reports, beneficiary lists, borrower KYC	Diversion and ghost beneficiaries; borrower ownership	Each OIG
Interior	Lease-level sales and valuation data	Royalty underpayment at the lease level	ONRR; DOI OIG
FDIC	Examination findings, loan-level data	Insider and borrower fraud before failure	FDIC OIG
NRC, EOP	Contract invoices; HIDTA grant reports	Ordinary contract and grant checks	Each OIG

Prosecution support

Finding fraud is not enough; cases must hold up. Phase 2 adds:

- **Evidence-grade pipeline.** Locked data snapshots, logged queries, versioned code and reproducible outputs, so an analyst can testify to how a result was produced.
- **Case packages for prosecutors.** For each referral: the scheme, the claims or payments involved, total loss, the people who received the money, and a list of records to subpoena.
- **Limitations triage.** Rank cases by time left: five years for most federal fraud statutes, ten years for bank fraud and for PPP and EIDL fraud, and up to ten years under the False Claims Act.
- **Recovery focus.** Trace payments to accounts and assets to support seizure and forfeiture.
- **Feedback loop.** Outcomes of referred cases feed back into scoring.

4.3 Access routes

Internal data comes through a small number of legal routes. They differ a lot in speed.

Route	How it works	Typical time to data	Best for
OIG partnership	Work under or alongside an Inspector General, who already has access under the IG Act and can act on findings	2-4 months	HHS, DoD, SBA, USDA, VA, OPM
Agency pilot and data use agreement	Program integrity office shares data for a defined pilot	3-6 months, plus security approval	CMS, FNS, GSA, FCC/USAC
Research data access	CMS Virtual Research Data Center and similar enclaves	3-6 months	HHS claims analytics without a partnership



Route	How it works	Typical time to data	Best for
Computer matching agreement	Required under the Privacy Act for many cross-agency matches; approved by Data Integrity Boards	6-12 months	Death data, identity reuse, cross-program matches
Treasury Do Not Pay	Treasury's central screening service, which already matches payments against death and exclusion data	3-6 months to join for a use case	Cross-agency payment screens
State agreements	Data from states that run the program (SNAP EBT, UI, Medicaid)	3-9 months per state	USDA, DOL, HHS Medicaid
Existing hubs	NASWA Integrity Data Hub (UI), CMS Healthcare Fraud Prevention Partnership (public-private health data sharing)	2-6 months	DOL, HHS

Two legal limits shape the plan:

- **Tax data (26 U.S.C. 6103)** can be shared only in narrow cases. IRS work should be done inside IRS or TIGTA, with us supplying methods and non-tax data, not by moving returns out.
- **Privacy Act and matching rules** mean cross-agency matching needs a matching agreement or an OIG exception. Starting with OIGs avoids the longest delays.

Recent policy may speed this up: the March 2025 executive order on eliminating information silos directs agencies to give designated officials access to unclassified records, and the 2026 anti-fraud task force makes cross-agency fraud work a stated priority. The precedent to point to is the Pandemic Response Accountability Committee's Pandemic Analytics Center of Excellence, which matched data across agencies for pandemic programs (check its current status: the committee's authority was set to end in September 2025).

4.4 Security and governance requirements

Agencies will ask for these before sharing data, so they are budgeted from the start of Phase 2:

- A government-authorized environment (FedRAMP Moderate or High, or working inside the agency's or OIG's own enclave).
- An authority to operate for any system that holds agency data.
- Personnel suitability or background checks for analysts.
- Privacy impact assessment, data retention and destruction rules.
- Model documentation: what each score uses, how it was tested, and checks for bias against protected groups or places.
- A governance board with the OIG, program office and counsel that approves new uses of data.
- A contract vehicle or interagency agreement to pay for the work.



4.5 Phase 2 timeline

Dates are estimates and depend mostly on how fast agreements are signed.

Period	Dates	Goal	Main actions
2a. Prepare	Jan - Mar 2027 (Phase 1 weeks 8-16)	Access proposals out	Six proposals in week 8 (HHS-OIG, DoD OIG, SBA OIG, USDA OIG, DHS/CBP, GSA); Treasury, SSA, DOL proposals in week 13; security plan and environment options; Phase 2 cost estimate
2b. Agree	Mar - Jun 2027	First two agreements signed	Pick two first pilots from the agencies that respond (likely HHS-OIG and one of DoD OIG or SBA OIG); data use agreements; environment authorized; analyst checks
2c. First pilots	Jul - Dec 2027	Claim- and invoice-level screens running	HHS: hospice and home health claim scoring. DoD or SBA: invoice and application screens. Weekly lead flow to the OIG; first case packages to prosecutors by Oct 2027
2d. Cross-agency	Oct 2027 - Jun 2028	First cross-agency match	Death data case with SSA and Do Not Pay; matching agreement for one cross-program identity screen (for example UI with SNAP through two states); add USDA, DHS and GSA pilots
2e. Scale	Jul - Dec 2028	Program model proven	Pre-payment checks in at least one program; results report for OMB and the task force; proposal for a government-wide shared service

4.6 Phase 2 action items (first six months)

ID	Action	Owner	Due
P1	Write the access proposal template: problem, Phase 1 findings, data asked for, route, security, timeline, success measures	Lead	2026-12-18 (Phase 1 week 7)
P2	Send six access proposals (HHS-OIG, DoD OIG, SBA OIG, USDA OIG, DHS/CBP, GSA)	Lead	2027-01-08
P3	Choose the secure environment approach (agency enclave, OIG enclave or our own authorized cloud) and estimate cost	DE	2027-01-29
P4	Send Treasury, SSA and DOL proposals, including the death data case	Lead	2027-02-12
P5	Request CMS research data access as a backup route for HHS analytics	AN	2027-02-12
P6	Phase 2 go/no-go with Steve: budget, first two pilots	Lead	2027-03-05
P7	Sign first data use agreement or OIG memorandum of understanding	Lead	2027-05-28
P8	Environment authorized and analysts cleared	DE	2027-06-25



ID	Action	Owner	Due
P9	First pilot live on internal data	AN	2027-07-30

4.7 Phase 2 success measures

- Agreements signed with at least two agencies or OIGs by 2027-06.
- First internal-data pilot producing leads by 2027-08.
- First prosecutor-ready case package by 2027-10.
- Dollars identified, recovered or prevented, reported each quarter with the method used to count them.
- One cross-agency match running by mid-2028.

5 Decisions for Steve

1. **Start date and team.** Is 2026-11-02 the right start, and who fills the five roles?
2. **Order.** Keep the top33.pdf order, or move a target agency forward because of a meeting or contact?
3. **Commercial data.** Budget for vessel manifests and a corporate registry service (decision F12)?
4. **Referral route.** Refer leads only to OIGs and DOJ, or also consider False Claims Act filings with counsel?
5. **First Phase 2 partners.** Lead with OIGs (fastest) or with program offices (closer to prevention)?

6 Sources

- Top 33 ranking and shared screens and the agency briefs it links, which list the program-level sources used here.
- Working plan
- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments
- GAO-24-105833: federal fraud losses estimated at $233B to $521B a year
- GAO-24-105470: SBIR/STTR fraud vulnerabilities
- GAO-26-108139: FEHB provider eligibility risks
- Oversight.gov: all Inspector General reports
- Treasury Do Not Pay
- CMS Healthcare Fraud Prevention Partnership
- NASWA Integrity Data Hub
- Privacy Act computer matching provisions (5 U.S.C. 552a(o))
- 26 U.S.C. 6103: confidentiality of tax returns
- DOJ whistleblower program terms

